United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization

Intangible Cultural Heritage

Organizing and storing information

Unit 33 PowerPoint presentation

UNESCO
Intangible Cultural Heritage Section

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In this presentation …

- Key issues
- What is the data to be organized?
- Cataloging
- Digital content
- Storage and preservation
- Community access

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Before you leave the fieldwork venue

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Verify:

- Facts
- Names of people, events, genres, objects, places
- Spellings

Remember: organization of data is reliant on what you collect

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Data rights issues

- Ensure all forms for free prior and informed consent are obtained and filed
- Transfer any conditions for access and use to documents and lists for further use
- Note if permission has been obtained for public or online access
- Thank and acknowledge all those who participated
- Arrange to send copies of photos/recordings if they have been promised

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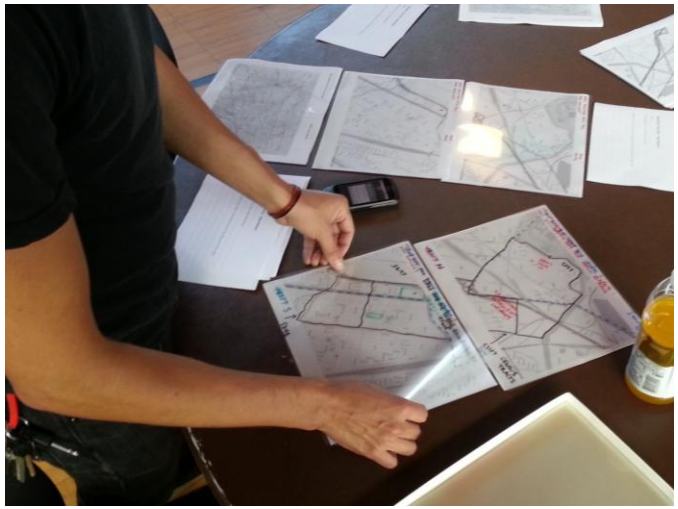
What is the data to be organized?



- Audio recordings
- Video recordings
- Photographs
- Notes
- Observations
- Interviews
- Information on audiovisual recordings and photos
- Artifacts, objects etc.

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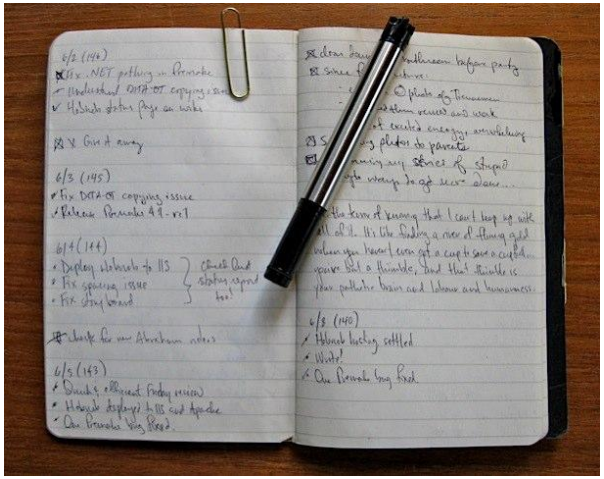
Revise, complete and follow up notes



- Further elaborate on rough field notes
- Add information that you can recollect
- Expand on abbreviations
- Check on doubts
- Sort and separate
- Interviews: find notes on recordings
- Check contact information and names
- Find ways of grouping data gathered

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Create logs

Check that documentation of recordings contains the following logs:

- ✓ Name and nature of event or interview
- ✓ Date and place
- ✓ People involved

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Collate materials

- Sort and list so that recordings, photos and notes for each event are together
- Provide numbering that links documents, recordings, photographs, logs and recording sheets

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Transcribe and translate

- Prepare tanscriptions and translation as required

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Cataloguing (1)

- What is the use of cataloguing?
    - museums
    - aid community and collaborators to locate and use information
    - other
- What form of cataloguing?
    - list
    - card catalog
    - database
    - spreadsheet
-

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Cataloguing (2)

- What function?
    - describe the materials in a systematic way
    - aid retrieval
- Language
    - use local names for genres, instruments, crafts
- Add general descriptions or translations
- Add images or other visual aids to improve access

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Exercise: organizing information

- What are the various headings you can think of for cataloguing the material you have collected?
- List all the ways in which you think the materials can be described?
- Which of these would be useful for searching specific images, recordings or written notes?
- Compile a list by combining everybody's inputs

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Data implications for digital content

- file formats rather than physical objects (audio, video and photography)
- Store safely – fragile!
- Logging and listing required
- Need for consistent naming systems

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Metadata

- ‘data about data’
- digital content
- contained and stored in all digital files
- can be stored outside the files in a database

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Storage and preservation

- Inventorying is not an end in itself, but contributes to safeguarding
- Preserve for use by the community concerned and others as appropriate
- Assign rights and control access
- Collaborate with archive for community access and outreach activities
- Preserve and disseminate

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Working towards storage (1)

- Awareness of standards of storing before starting the process
- Catalogue all materials with community participation
- Note all issues of rights and access to provide to the storage institution for successful administration of the data gathered
- Store all original materials even after digitization

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Working towards storage (2)

- Audio recordings, video recording and images should be stored in a digital storage system that has a back-up
- All materials should have two back ups
- Working copies, reference copies, access copies
- Notes, paper and print material should also be digitised – through scanning or photography
- Attempt high standards of digitisation with lower resolution for access purposes
- Store originals if not deposited in cool, dust free environment, away from direct sunlight

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Community access

- Attempt to fund copies for practitioners
- Create or assist in creating community, museum, or media centre
- Deposit copies in such a centre if it exists
- While depositing in an archive not directly controlled by the community, assure community access as part of the agreement
- Community access should involve getting copies, ability to create and recreate materials
- Any benefits from inventoried materials must assure community benefit

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Published in 2016 by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization, 7, place de Fontenoy, 75352 Paris 07 SP, France

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